

Companies House Data Store handbook

This is the walkthrough I would give you if we were sitting at the same screen. It covers what the dashboard is for, what every control does, and what the numbers on it actually mean. It is not about how the thing is built.

The short version of what it does is: it holds **1,531,094 active UK companies** from the July 2026 Companies House snapshot, joins six external sources onto them, and gives you two ways in. You either **start from a question** ("who has borrowed before, cleared it, and has nobody holding security today?") and get a list, or you **start from a company** and get everything we know about it on one page. There is also an Analytics page that steps back and describes the whole market rather than any one company.

One thing to be clear about from the start, because it changes how you should read everything below. This tells you what companies are *doing*: taking on secured borrowing, falling behind on filings, losing a lender, winning public work. It does **not** tell you which Lloyds product to sell them. That step is yours. Nothing in here maps a company to a facility, and where I use words like "prospect" I mean a company worth a conversation, not a company the model says will buy something.

Getting it running

The dashboard is a single page served by a small local query server. From the repository root:

```
python dashboard/serve.py
```

It opens a browser at `http://127.0.0.1:8000` on its own. Add `--no-browser` if you would rather open it yourself.

If you are working inside Claude Code, prefix the command with `!` so it runs in your own shell rather than the assistant's, and give the full paths:

```
! <path-to-python>\python.exe <path-to-repo>\dashboard\serve.py --no-browser
```

Use the Python that has `duckdb`, `flask` and `pandas` installed, which on most of our machines is the Anaconda one rather than the default. Then open `http://127.0.0.1:8000` yourself.

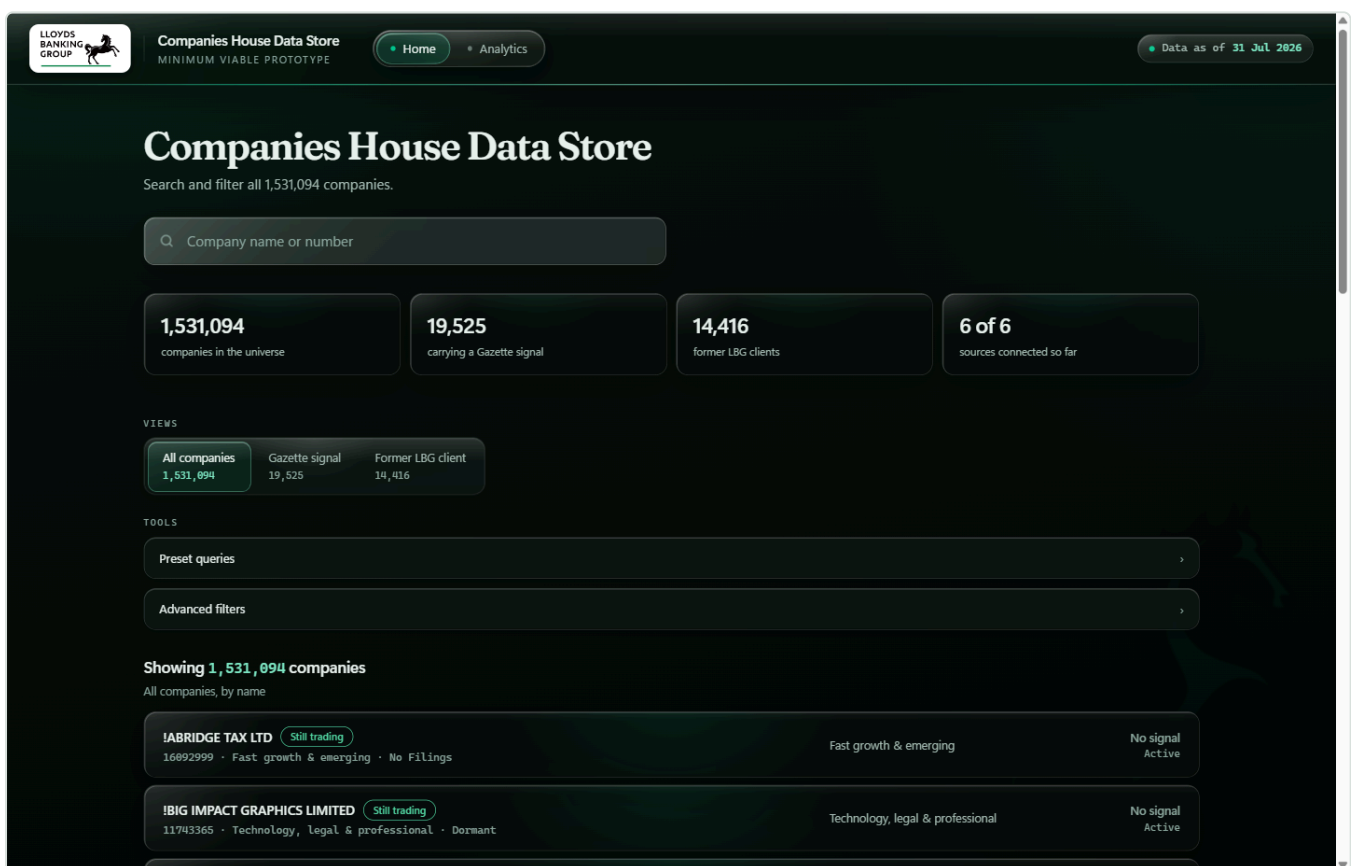
Either way it takes fifteen seconds or so to start, because it loads the company file and six side tables into memory before it answers anything, and it prints what it found while it does:

```
data      : <your data folder>
parquet   : ...\\dashboard_bulk_gazette_2026-07.parquet
universe: 1,531,094 companies queryable
loading side tables ...
serving   : http://127.0.0.1:8000   (Ctrl+C to stop)
```

If the data lives somewhere else on your machine, point it there with `--data <folder>` or by setting `LLOYDS_DATA` . If it cannot find the file it will tell you exactly what it was looking for rather than failing with a stack trace.

A short branded clip plays while the page loads. It lifts on its own after about four seconds, or you can click anywhere or press Escape to skip it. You will see it again on a refresh but not when moving between Home and Analytics.

The shape of the thing



Everything on Home reads top to bottom in the order you would use it.

The **four numbers** across the top are the scale you are working at. 1,531,094 companies in the file, 19,525 carrying a Gazette signal, 14,416 former Lloyds clients, six of six sources connected.

Views are the three starting populations. They are not filters, they are three different questions, and each one sorts on something different:

View	What it is	Sorted by
All companies	Everything, 1,531,094	Company name
Gazette signal	The 19,525 with an insolvency notice against them	Furthest through the distress ladder, most recent first
Former LBG client	The 14,416 who held secured lending with us and no longer do	Most recently lapsed first

Pick a view first, then narrow it. Filters always apply *inside* whichever view is selected, so "Gazette signal" plus a Manufacturing filter gives you distressed manufacturers, not all manufacturers.

Tools holds the two ways of narrowing: Preset queries and Advanced filters. Both are drawers, both start closed, and both stay where you left them.

Underneath is the count line, which always tells you two numbers once you have filtered anything: **Showing 2,303 of 1,531,094 companies**. The **Clear all** button next to it puts you back to the full population.

Looking up one company

The search box takes a **name or a company number** and matches on both. Type **TESCO** and you get the Tesco companies. Type **12723324** and you get that exact company. Partial names work, so **PRINTER SPECIAL** will find the printer specialists.

This is the right way in when you already have a company in mind: a name from a call, a number off a credit paper, a business you drove past. For everything else, start from a question instead.

Quick queries: the nine presets

The screenshot shows the 'Companies House Data Store' dashboard. At the top, there's a header with the Lloyds Banking Group logo, the title 'Companies House Data Store', a subtitle 'MINIMUM VIABLE PROTOTYPE', and navigation links for 'Home' and 'Analytics'. A date filter on the right indicates 'Data as of 31 Jul 2026'.

Below the header, there's a 'VIEWS' section with three buttons: 'All companies' (1,531,094), 'Gazette signal' (19,525), and 'Former LBG client' (14,416). Below this is a 'TOOLS' section with a 'Preset queries' dropdown menu. A tooltip explains that each preset is a combination checked to return a meaningful population and that clicking one loads its conditions into the 'Advanced filters' section.

The 'Preset queries' section lists nine queries with their respective counts:

- Proven borrower, no incumbent: 31,082
- Established, unlevered, high growth: 31,012
- Best prospects we don't bank: 8,992
- Secured exposure deteriorating: 5,916
- Growing and borrowing: 3,689
- Silent distress, no Gazette yet: 2,528
- Contract winner with no borrowing: 2,383
- Lapsed client, rival moved in: 467
- High credit risk on our security: 401

Below the preset queries is an 'Advanced filters' section. The main content area shows 'Showing 1,531,094 companies' and 'All companies, by name'. It lists four companies with their details:

Company Name	Status	Details	Category	Signal
!ABRIDGE TAX LTD	Still trading	16092999 · Fast growth & emerging · No Filings	Fast growth & emerging	No signal Active
!BIG IMPACT GRAPHICS LIMITED	Still trading	11743365 · Technology, legal & professional · Dormant	Technology, legal & professional	No signal Active
!INFLECTION ADVISORY LIMITED	Still trading	15073164 · Technology, legal & professional · Small	Technology, legal & professional	No signal Active
!INFOGENIE LTD	Still trading	13522064 · Technology, legal & professional · Micro	Technology, legal & professional	No signal Active

These are the fastest thing in the dashboard and the place I would start. Each one is a combination that has been checked to return a population worth looking at, and each answers a commercial question you would recognise.

Preset	Companies	What it means
Proven borrower, no incumbent	31,002	Borrowed before and cleared it. No incumbent to displace.
Established, unlevered, high growth	31,012	Five years trading, never borrowed, top 10% growth.
Best prospects we don't bank	8,992	Top 1% for new borrowing, never an LBG client.
Secured exposure deteriorating	5,916	Security is held and the company has stopped filing on time.
Growing and borrowing	3,609	Expanding and actively taking on secured debt.
Silent distress, no Gazette yet	2,520	Both filing signals failed, nothing has reached the Gazette.
Contract winner with no borrowing	2,303	Just won public work, never borrowed. Delivery needs working capital.
Lapsed client, rival moved in	467	Left us, and a competitor took a charge within 6 months.
High credit risk on our security	401	Top 1% insolvency risk where LBG holds an outstanding charge.

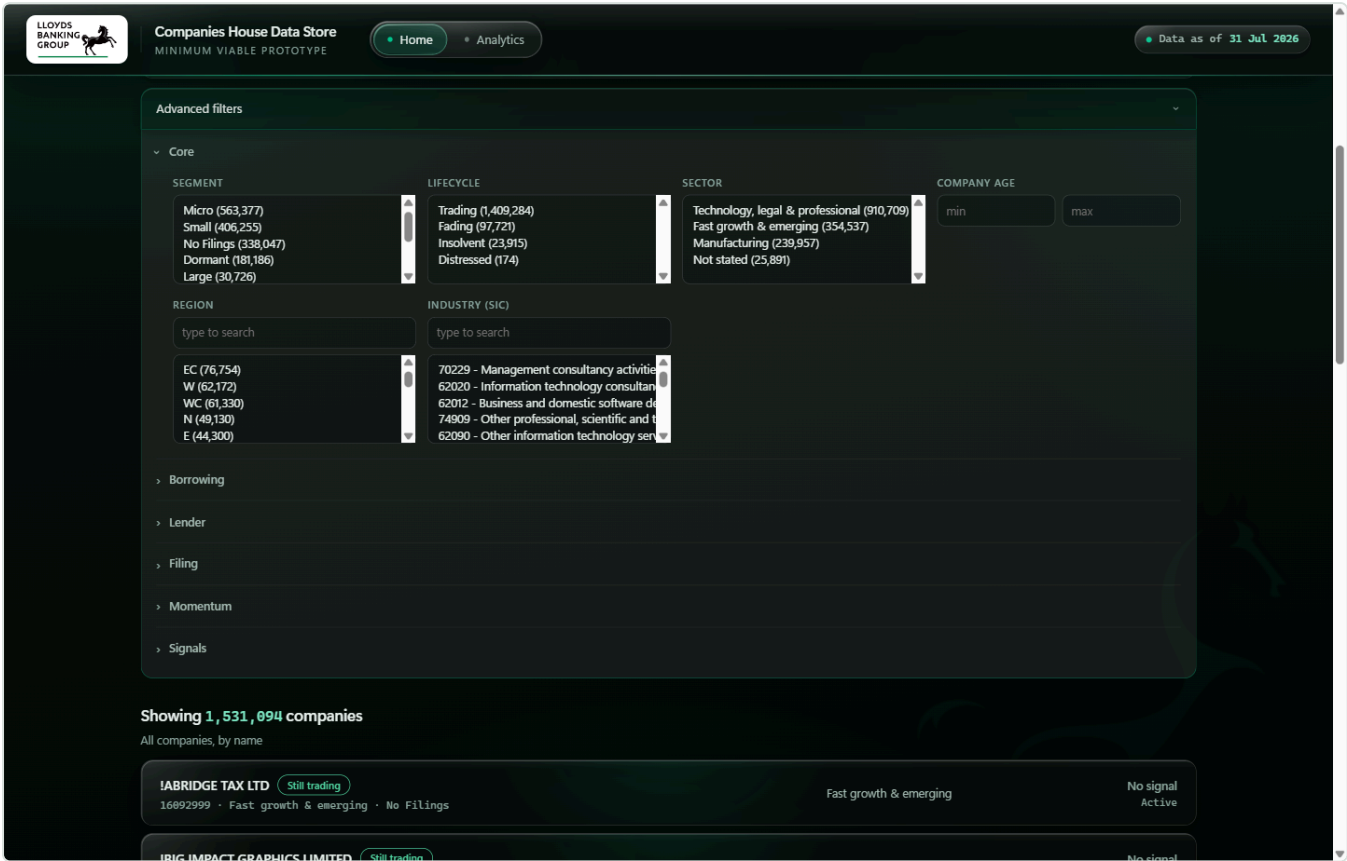
Click one and the list rebuilds. Click the same one again and it comes off. Only one preset is active at a time, so picking a second replaces the first rather than stacking.

The part worth knowing: picking a preset does not just filter the list, it **loads its conditions into**

Advanced filters. Open the filter drawer after applying one and you will see exactly which boxes it ticked. That means you can take a preset as a starting point and then loosen or tighten any part of it, which is usually more useful than either the preset or a blank filter panel on its own.

Eight of the nine work that way. **Contract winner with no borrowing** is the exception: one of its conditions, "won a public contract in the last 12 months", has no matching control in the filter panel, so that preset cannot be unpacked and edited. The dashboard says so rather than pretending, and lists its four conditions in plain text instead.

Advanced filters



Twenty-seven filters in six groups. Every option carries its own count, so you can see how much a choice will cost you before you make it. Groups start collapsed apart from Core.

Core is who the company is. Segment (Micro 563,377, Small 406,255, No Filings 338,047, Dormant 181,186, Large 30,726, and so on), Sector, Company age, Region by postcode area, and Industry by SIC code with a search box because there are hundreds of them.

Lifecycle sits in Core and is worth understanding properly, because it is not the same as the raw Companies House status. It collapses that status into four states you can act on:

Lifecycle	Companies	Underlying status
Trading	1,409,284	Active
Fading	97,721	Active, proposal to strike off
Distressed	174	Receiver on a charge, or a voluntary arrangement
Insolvent	23,915	Administration, receivership or liquidation

Borrowing is the charge register. *Ever borrowed* is whether a charge was ever registered. *Outstanding mortgages* is how many are live now. *Repayment state* splits into fully repaid, partly repaid and all outstanding. *New charge in 12m* is recent borrowing activity.

Lender is who they bank with. *LBG relationship* is the big one: current client, former client, or never a client. *Main lender* is whoever holds most of their outstanding borrowing. *Number of lenders*, *competitor lender present*, and two timing filters for when a competitor took a charge.

Filing is administrative health, and it is the most underrated group here. Accounts overdue, overdue by six months or more, confirmation statement late, no filing at all for 24 months. These are the signals that move before anything reaches the Gazette.

Momentum is what changed in the last twelve months: size tier moved up or down, relocated, industry changed. These are three-state rather than yes/no, because a company with no history to compare against is genuinely different from one that did not move, and the dashboard will not pretend otherwise.

Signals is where the model scores live, as Top 1% or Top 10% bands for lending readiness, growth and credit risk, plus the Gazette filters (any notice, severity, court involved, winding-up petition, notice in the last 90 or 365 days).

Combining them

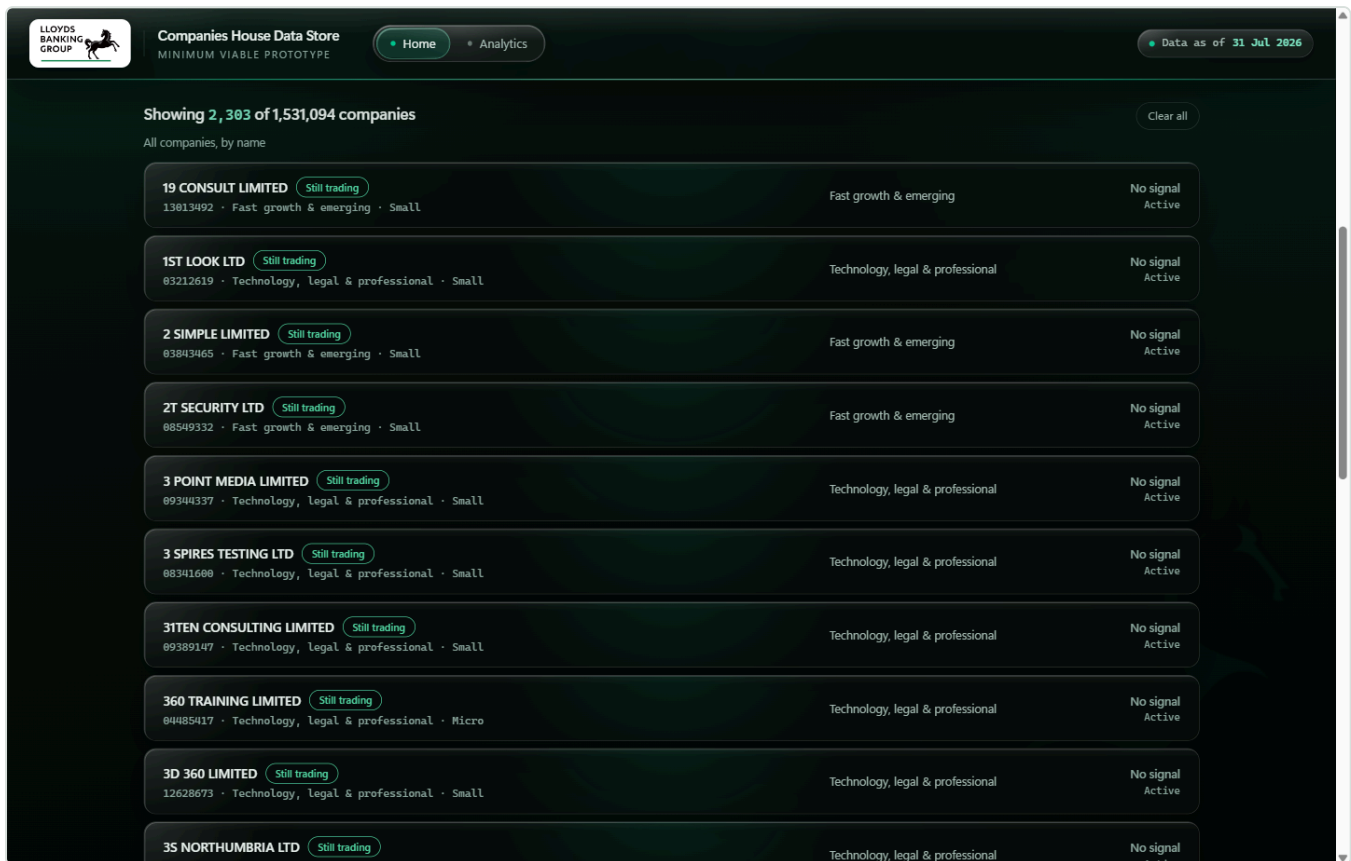
Everything ANDs together, and everything sits inside the view you picked. Taking Manufacturing as an example, the same filter means three different things depending on where you start:

Starting view	Add Manufacturing	You are looking at
All companies	239,957	Every manufacturer
Gazette signal	5,188	Manufacturers already in insolvency proceedings
Former LBG client	6,190	Manufacturers who used to borrow from us

Because each option shows its own count, you can usually see a dead end coming before you commit to it. And if you do land on nothing, the dashboard names the filter that emptied the list and offers to undo just that one, instead of showing you a blank box.

A zero can be the answer rather than a mistake. Apply *Silent distress* inside the Gazette signal view and you get exactly **0** companies. That is correct and it is worth understanding, because it tells you the two things are opposites by construction: silent distress means the filing signals have failed and **nothing has reached the Gazette yet**, so intersecting it with companies that have a Gazette notice can only ever be empty. Same preset in the Former LBG view returns 59, which is a genuinely interesting list.

Reading the results



The screenshot shows the 'Companies House Data Store' interface. At the top, there's a header with the Lloyds Banking Group logo, the text 'Companies House Data Store' and 'MINIMUM VIABLE PROTOTYPE', navigation links for 'Home' and 'Analytics', and a date filter 'Data as of 31 Jul 2026'. Below the header, it says 'Showing 2,303 of 1,531,094 companies' with a 'Clear all' button. The main content is a table of companies, with the first few rows visible. Each row contains a company name with a 'Still trading' chip, a company number, a sector and size description, a sector name, and a signal status.

Company Name	Company Number	Sector & Size	Sector	Signal Status
19 CONSULT LIMITED Still trading	13013492	Fast growth & emerging · Small	Fast growth & emerging	No signal Active
1ST LOOK LTD Still trading	03212619	Technology, legal & professional · Small	Technology, legal & professional	No signal Active
2 SIMPLE LIMITED Still trading	03843465	Fast growth & emerging · Small	Fast growth & emerging	No signal Active
2T SECURITY LTD Still trading	00549332	Fast growth & emerging · Small	Fast growth & emerging	No signal Active
3 POINT MEDIA LIMITED Still trading	09344337	Technology, legal & professional · Small	Technology, legal & professional	No signal Active
3 SPIRES TESTING LTD Still trading	00341600	Technology, legal & professional · Small	Technology, legal & professional	No signal Active
3ITEN CONSULTING LIMITED Still trading	09389147	Technology, legal & professional · Small	Technology, legal & professional	No signal Active
360 TRAINING LIMITED Still trading	04485417	Technology, legal & professional · Micro	Technology, legal & professional	No signal Active
3D 360 LIMITED Still trading	12628673	Technology, legal & professional · Small	Technology, legal & professional	No signal Active
3S NORTHUMBRIA LTD Still trading			Technology, legal & professional	No signal Active

Each row gives you four things: the company name with its lifecycle chip, the company number and sector and size underneath, the sector again in the middle column, and on the right whatever the current view cares about.

That right-hand column changes with the view, which catches people out. In All companies it shows the Gazette signal state. In Gazette signal it shows the distress stage and the date of the last notice. In Former LBG client it shows how many competitor lenders they have now and when our charge was satisfied. The list is showing you the thing you asked about.

You get 25 rows at a time, and there is a **Show more** button at the foot of the list that tells you how many are left behind it: **Show more · 1,531,069 remaining**. It does not load on scroll, so a long list will not run away with you. Clicking anywhere on a row opens that company.

Inside a company profile

← All companies

THE PRINTER SPECIALISTS
(IRELAND) LTD

NI614488 · Insolvent · Liquidation · Incorporated 17 Sept 2012

85B MAIN STREET, MOIRA, BT67 0LH

33140 - Repair of electrical equipment

Manufacturing Small News not searched

WHY THIS COMPANY IS IN YOUR LIST

VIEW Gazette signal

GAZETTE ASSESSMENT

Final meeting stage 5 of 5

Severity Terminal

Notices 5 total · 1 in 12m

First notice 6 Jun 2025

Last notice 31 Jul 2026

Days since 0

Match company number

Escalated a stage Recurring distress

Notice in last 90 days

Read straight from Gazette notices. These are recorded facts with a date and a link, not a score or an opinion.

MODEL SCORES

Not scored — status is "Liquidation".

The four models are fitted only on companies whose status is exactly Active: 1,409,284 of 1,531,094 in the file. Companies in liquidation, administration or receivership sit outside the scored population. A forecast for such a company would be a number with nothing behind it, so nothing is shown rather than a zero.

LENDER RELATIONSHIP

Relationship No LBG relationship

Outstanding charges 1

Held by LBG 0

Distinct lenders 1

Competitor lenders 0

Main lender not identified

Months since LBG charge created never

Months since LBG charge satisfied never

Read from the Companies House charge register. Descriptive only: no lender field fed any model score.

TIMELINE · EVERY SOURCE, ONE COLUMN

- 6 Jun 2025 GAZETTE Meetings of Creditors
- 3 Jul 2025 GAZETTE Appointment of Liquidators
- 3 Jul 2025 GAZETTE Notices to Creditors
- 3 Jul 2025 GAZETTE Resolutions for Winding-up
- 31 Jul 2026 GAZETTE Final Meetings

GAZETTE

5 notices
most recent 31 Jul 2026

NEWS

not searched
467 of 1,531,094 companies
sampled

CONTRACTS

none found
as at 31 May 2026

PROPERTY

none held
as at 29 Jun 2026

TRADE MARKS

none found
register to 28 Jan 2018

GRANTS

no match
name match only · as at 11
Aug 2026

EVIDENCE

Gazette notice 4899998 certain match

Gazette notice 4918720 certain match

Gazette notice 4918719 certain match

Gazette notice 4918718 certain match

Gazette notice 6183488 certain match

BORROWING PROFILE

Charges ever registered 1

Currently outstanding 1

Satisfied 0

Debt ratio 1.00

New charges, 12m 0

Change, 3m 0

Months since last new charge never

Debt ratio is outstanding charges over all charges ever registered. A months-since of "never" means no charge has ever been taken, not one taken long ago.

FILING HEALTH

Accounts overdue yes, 13 months

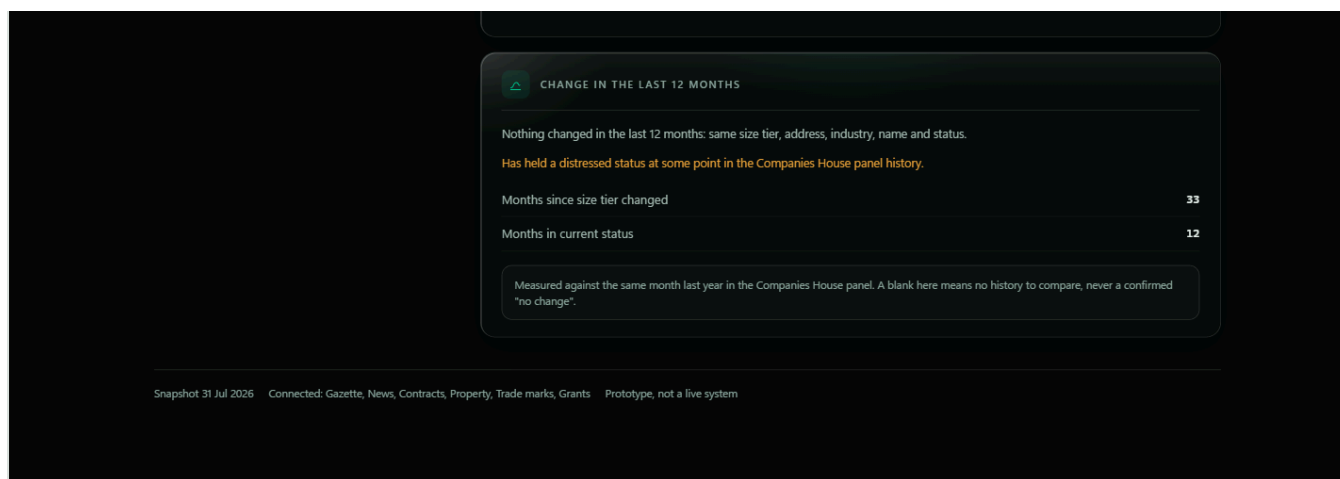
Confirmation statement late

Days to next accounts due 366 days overdue

Months since last accounts 34

Months since last statement 22

Months without any filing 10



The header gives you identity: name, company number, lifecycle chip, registered status, incorporation date, address, SIC code, and chips for sector and size.

The chips, and what each one is telling you

Small labels turn up all over the profile and they are not decoration. There are three families and they mean quite different things.

On the header. The first chip is lifecycle (*Still trading, Insolvent, Fading, Distressed*), then sector and size. The last one is easy to misread: **News not searched** is a statement about our coverage, not about the company. It means this company was not one of the 467 we searched. It is never a claim that the company has had no press.

On the Gazette panel. These describe the *pattern* of notices rather than any single one, and they are the ones worth acting on:

Chip	What it is saying
Escalated a stage	They have moved further down the distress ladder, not just repeated a step
Recurring distress	More than one episode, rather than a single event
Notice in last 90 days	This is live, not history

On the Evidence panel. Every Gazette notice is listed with a **certain match** chip and a link straight to the notice on the Gazette. That panel is the audit trail: it exists so that nothing on the page has to be taken on trust. If a profile claims five notices, the Evidence panel is where you go to read all five. "Certain match" means the notice was matched on company number rather than by name.

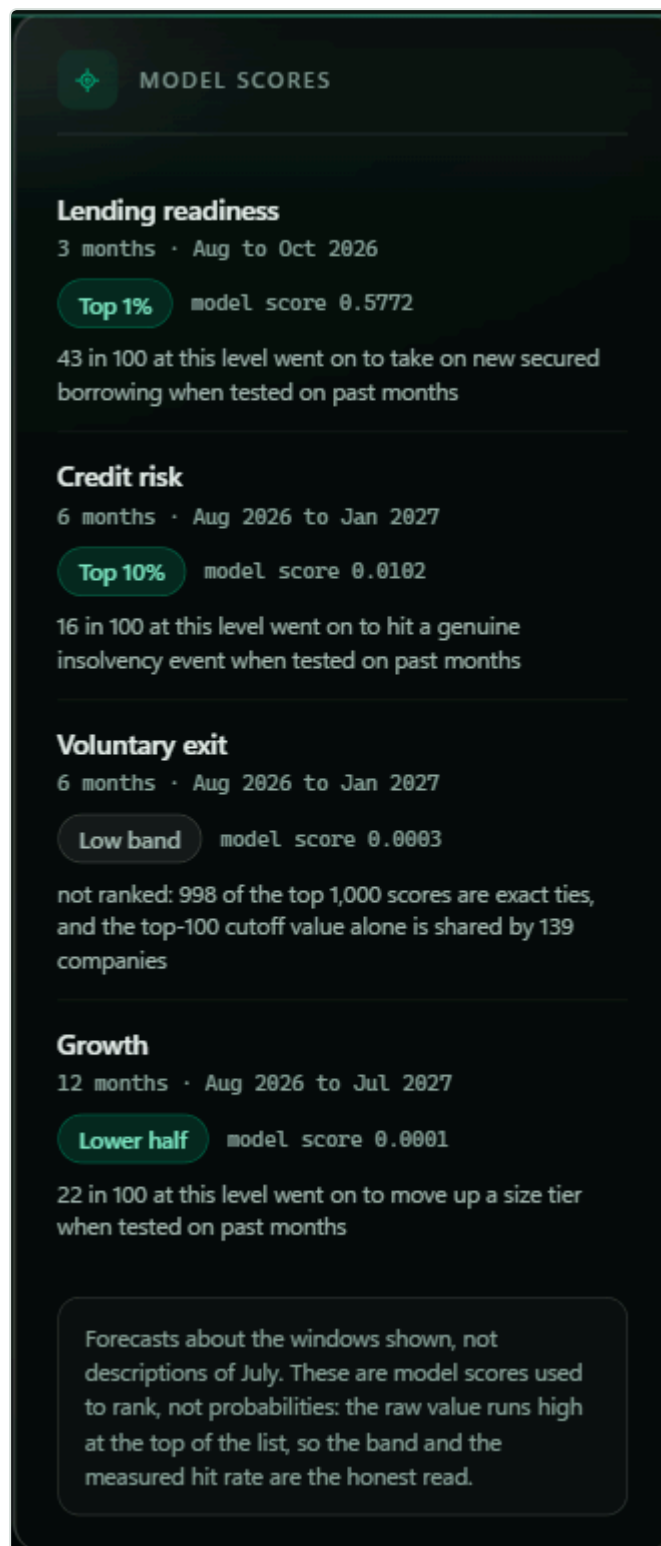
A related label appears on Grants, which is matched on **name and postcode area** rather than company number, so it carries a confidence and says "name match only" on the tile. Treat those as strong hints rather than facts, which is exactly how the dashboard presents them.

Why this company is in your list



If you arrived from a filtered list, this bar tells you which view, preset and filters put the company in front of you. It is easy to lose track after a few clicks, and this is the answer to "hang on, why am I looking at this one?".

The model scores



Four models, each predicting a different event over a different window. They are shown as a **band** rather than a raw number, and with the measured hit rate underneath.

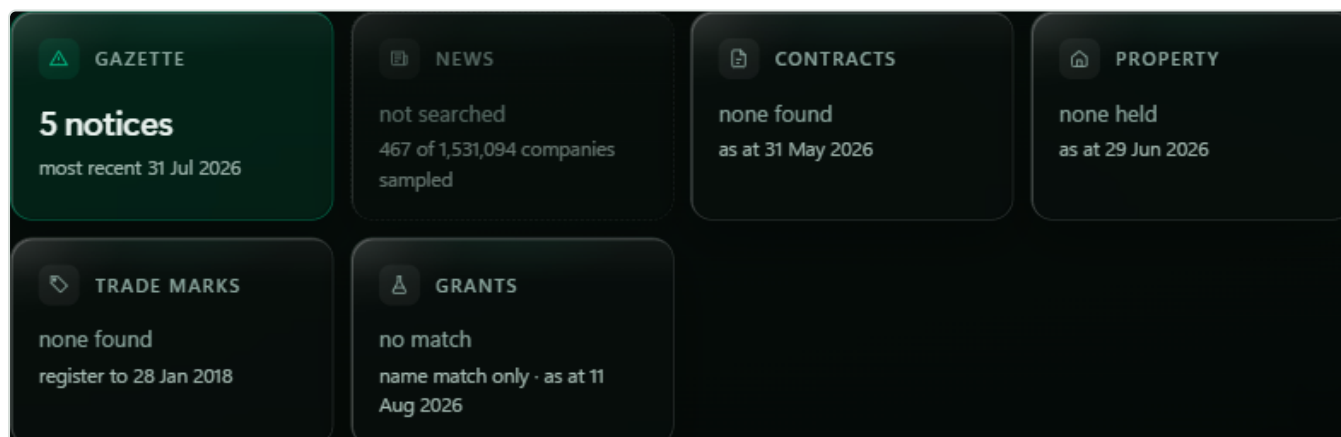
Score	Window	What it predicts	Hit rate at the top
Lending readiness	3 months	Takes on new secured borrowing	43 in 100
Credit risk	6 months	Hits a genuine insolvency event	16 in 100
Voluntary exit	6 months	Has a strike-off proposal filed	not ranked
Growth	12 months	Moves up a size tier	22 in 100

Read the band and the hit rate, not the raw score. The panel says so itself, and the reason is that the raw value bunches hard at the top of the list, so the difference between 0.577 and 0.412 is not the difference it looks like.

Voluntary exit is deliberately not ranked, and the panel explains why on the company: 998 of the top 1,000 scores are exact ties, and the top-100 cutoff value alone is shared by 139 companies. A ranking built on that would be arbitrary, so it is not offered.

Scores only exist for companies whose status is exactly Active. That is 1,409,284 of the 1,531,094. For the other 121,810 the panel does not show zeros, it disappears and says why: "Not scored, status is Liquidation". A forecast for a company already in liquidation would be a number with nothing behind it.

The six sources



Six tiles, one per source, and the state of each tile is information in itself. There are three states and the difference between the second and third matters:

- **Green with a figure.** We looked and found something. Click it to open the detail.
- **Plain, "none found" with a date.** We looked, on that date, and there was nothing. This is a finding, not a gap.
- **Dashed and dimmed, "not searched".** We did not look at this company. Absence here means nothing at all.

The dates on the tiles are not decoration. Contracts is as at 31 May 2026, Property as at 29 Jun 2026, the Trade marks register runs to 28 Jan 2018, Grants as at 11 Aug 2026. A source can only tell you about the period it covers.

Gazette is insolvency notices, matched on company number, so a hit is certain rather than probable. Where a company has notices you get a severity tier, a stage on a five-step distress ladder, the notice count, first and last dates, and flags like escalated a stage, recurring distress, notice in the last 90 days.

Contracts is public sector awards. **Property** is Land Registry titles, matched on company number. **Trade marks** is the IPO register, live and lapsed. **Grants** is UKRI research funding, matched on name and postcode area rather than number, so it carries a confidence and says so.

News deserves its own paragraph, because the result looks like a bug and is not. Only **467** of the 1,531,094 companies were searched at all, and of those, **zero** produced coverage that survived verification. Fifteen produced raw hits that were rejected on review, mostly common-word company names matching unrelated stories. That is the finding: UK SMEs are essentially invisible in national news, and a pipeline that refused to count unverified matches is the pipeline working. Do not read "not searched" on a news tile as "no coverage".

Timeline, lender and borrowing

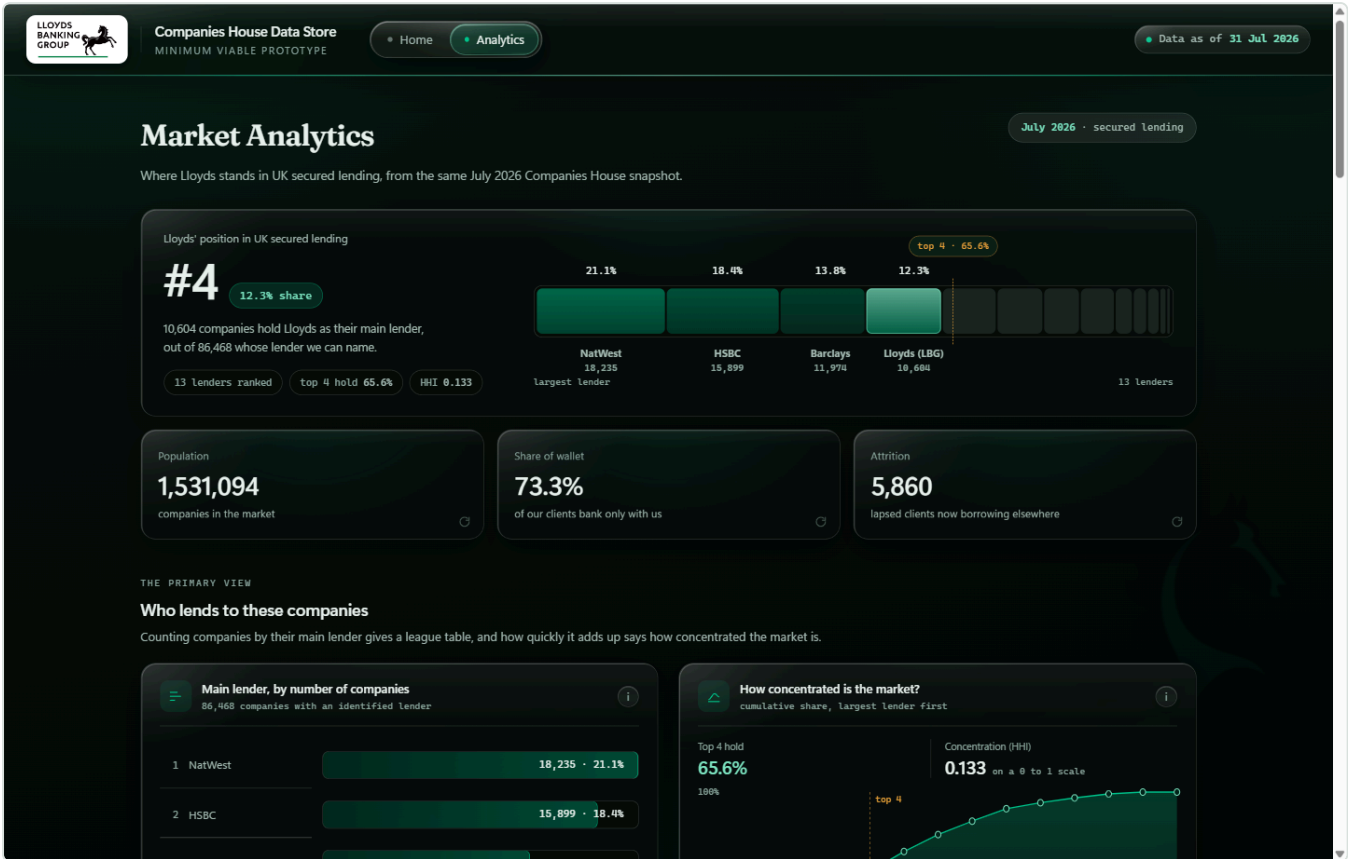
The **timeline** puts every dated event from every source into one column in date order, so you can see a contract win and a Gazette notice in relation to each other rather than in separate panels.

Lender relationship is the competitive picture: whether they are a current, former or never client, how many charges we hold, how many distinct lenders they have, who the main lender is, and how many months since our charge was created or satisfied.

Borrowing profile is the charge register itself: charges ever registered, currently outstanding, satisfied, the debt ratio, and how long since the last new charge.

Filing health and **Change in the last 12 months** are the administrative signals. The change panel is careful about blanks: it tells you how many of its checks have no twelve-month history to compare against, because a blank there means "we cannot say", never "nothing changed".

The Analytics page



Home is about companies. Analytics is about the market, and it answers a different question: where does Lloyds actually stand in UK secured lending?

The band at the top is the headline. **Lloyds is fourth with 12.3%** of the companies whose lender can be named from the charge register. That universe is 86,468 companies, not the full 1.5 million, and the page says so, because only a small share of companies have a charge with an identifiable lender behind it.



The league table and the concentration curve are the same finding read two ways. NatWest leads on 18,235 companies, then HSBC, then Barclays, then us on 10,604. The curve shows how fast the market adds up: the **top four hold 65.6%**, with an HHI of 0.133. Clear leaders, no monopoly.

Below that, eleven figures in five movements. Knowing what is there saves you scrolling for it:

Movement	Figures
The primary view	Main lender league table; how concentrated the market is
The market at a glance	Companies by sector; by size band; how old they are
Detail, by bank	Share of each sector's borrowers, as a heatmap
Our book	Share of a client's borrowing that is ours; how contested the book is; clients under pressure
Where clients went	Destination of lapsed clients now borrowing elsewhere; borrowing by sector and our share of it

Two numbers from our book worth carrying around. Of 11,733 current clients, **73.3% borrow only from us**. And of the 14,416 who have lapsed, **5,860 now borrow elsewhere while 8,556 have no live borrowing at all**, which means most of them stopped rather than switched. That distinction changes what you would do about it.

Every card has a small **i** button that opens a plain-English note on how to read that chart, and the three KPI cards at the top flip over when you click them to show the same thing. Charts with more than five rows show the top five and keep the rest behind a **Show all** button. The age histogram tags each bar on hover, so you can ask what a spike is.

Two things to know about this page. Nothing on it is recalculated in the browser, and **none of it responds to the filters on Home**. It always describes the whole market, so you cannot filter Analytics down to a segment. If you want to know about a slice, that is a Home question.

Some things to actually try

Work down this table and you will have used every part of the dashboard at least once.

Try this	Where to go	What it shows you
Loosen a preset	<i>Best prospects we don't bank</i> , then open Advanced filters and change Lending readiness from Top 1% to Top 10%	The list goes from 8,992 to 102,820 . Teaches you how presets and filters relate, and how much one band was holding back
Find distress before it is public	Compare the <i>Gazette signal</i> view against the <i>Silent distress</i> preset	19,525 already in trouble, against 2,520 still trading with both filing signals failed and nothing filed yet
See a zero that is an answer	Apply <i>Silent distress</i> while the <i>Gazette signal</i> view is selected	Returns 0 , correctly. The two are opposites by construction
Watch several sources fire at once	01088345 ANTALIS LIMITED	Property, trade marks and contracts all lit on one profile
Read the working capital story	08664789 CONSTELLIA PUBLIC LTD	64 public contracts in twelve months, never registered a charge
Look at a genuine prospect	12723324 MS LENDING GROUP LIMITED	Top 1% lending readiness, never an LBG client
Reach the end of the distress ladder	06624900 BNN TECHNOLOGY PLC	Terminal severity, five notices, and we hold security
Check the audit trail	Any Gazette company, then the Evidence panel	Every notice listed with a certain-match chip and a link to the notice itself
Build a question the presets miss	Former LBG client view, add <i>Competitor charge created (6m)</i> , add Manufacturing	230 companies: manufacturers who left us and whom a rival has just lent to
Step back from companies entirely	The Analytics page	Where Lloyds actually sits: fourth, 12.3%, in a market where the top four hold 65.6%

One to try last, because it is the one most likely to mislead you. Open **02634371 (UNION PENSION TRUSTEES LIMITED)** and you will see ten rival lenders and 225 outstanding LBG charges. Before reading anything into that, it is a trustee company: the register is recording custody on behalf of clients, not a trading balance sheet. The same caveat applies at the extreme end of the property data. It is a useful reminder that the register sometimes describes a legal arrangement rather than a business, and that the dashboard reports what the register says rather than interpreting it for you.

A last word on reading it honestly

Three habits will keep you out of trouble when using the dashboard.

Check what the right-hand column is showing you, because it changes with the view and it is easy to read a distress stage as though it were a signal state.

Treat "not searched" and "none found" as different things. One is an absence of evidence, the other is evidence of absence, and the tiles are careful to distinguish them even when the distinction is inconvenient.

Take the band, not the score. Every model panel tells you the measured hit rate for companies at that level, and that number is the honest read. 43 in 100 is a good signal. It is not a certainty, and the panel would rather say so than round it up for you.